

By LESTER KOELLING
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MINNEAPOLIS — It won't ever appear in the record book, but Vince Garcia has done something that probably never has been done before in the American Association.

The unusual feat accomplished by the Indianapolis second baseman is hitting first-inning doubles for two different teams in two successive years for the first hits in Minneapolis home-openers.



Koelling

Last year, with Wichita, Vince led off here with a two-bagger, the first hit to be scored in the new stadium, and Wichita defeated Minneapolis. Yesterday, with Indianapolis, Garcia doubled after a walk to Don Prohovich for the first hit here of the 1957 season. The Indians won, 7-3.

"I always hit good against Minneapolis," Vince related, "and Louisville, too. I don't know what it is, I just seem to hit."

Garcia picked up three of the Tribe's 12 hits yesterday as vengeance was gained against Stu Miller, who had tossed a six-inning no-hitter in the Indianapolis home-opener. Barry Latman, the loser to Miller in that 1-0 rain-soaked encounter, shared in the vengeance proceedings by going the route on a seven-hitter for his first victory.

SURE FUN TO WIN, BEAMS ANDY COHEN

All in all, as three different Minneapolis writers proclaimed in their opening paragraphs, "It was a lovely day for baseball."

It was an especially lovely day for Manager Andy Cohen, who received a portable radio from the Minneapolis management, who renewed acquaintances with scores of friends, who was successful in having a base-runner take an extra base and in working the squeeze play, and above all in walking off the field with a victory.

"Almost forgot how it felt to win," beamed Andy in the dressing room. "Sure is a grand feeling, isn't it? That boy Latman had good control and his curve ball was much better. All the kid needs is confidence and then he will gain consistency that should make him a great pitcher. This victory will do him a lot of good."

Latman never appeared in serious trouble after the first, the only inning in which the Millers obtained more than one hit. He fanned eight during